



The Black Button

Language level: Upper-intermediate (B2.1)
– Advanced (C1)

Learner type: Teens and adults

Time: 90 minutes

Activity: Watching a short film clip,
speaking, reading, listening and writing

Topic: Moral dilemmas

Language: Second conditional

Materials: Short film, video, moral
dilemma worksheets and video transcript



Overview

This lesson is designed around a short film called *The Black Button* by [Dark Heart Productions](#) and the themes of moral dilemmas. Students practise reading, reading and listening.

Step 1

Write *Moral Dilemma* on the board. Ask your students if they know what a moral dilemma is, ask them for examples.

Step 2

Tell me that you would like to talk about two moral dilemmas in small groups. Pre-teach any difficult vocabulary in the first moral dilemma, then give them the worksheet and let them read it for five minutes. Tell them they should decide what they would do in the situation. Put them into small groups and give them ten minutes to discuss the situation and their decisions.

Step 3

After 10 minutes get feedback from each group.

Step 4

Repeat steps 2 and 3 with moral dilemma 2.

Step 5

Tell your students they are going to watch the first part of a short film based on a moral dilemma. As they watch the film they should answer the question:

What is the moral dilemma?

Show the film until 4:56.

Link: <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QrKnh0J-R80>

Step 6

Discuss the moral dilemma and ask the following questions:

What would you do in this situation?

What do you think the man will do?

Step 7

Show the film until the man presses the button, pause at 5:26.

Discuss the man's decision.

Ask the following question:

What do you think the other man is going to tell him?

Step 8

Show the rest of the film. Ask your students what they think the message of the film is.

Step 9

Tell your students one interpretation is that the man has sold his soul for money. Ask them if they agree. Write the following proverb on the board:

Money is the root of all evil.

Ask them if they agree.

Step 10

Write the following question on the board:

What would you do with your life if money was no object?

Put students in pairs and ask them to discuss the question.

Step 11

Tell your students they are going to watch a short video based on part of a lecture by Alan Watts which asks the question "What would you do if money was no object?"

Show the film and ask students if they agree with Alan Watts.

Link: <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LHsLw2ge-S8>

Step 12

Give students the transcript of the lecture and ask them to read it for 5 minutes then show the video a second time.

Homework

Ask your students to write a composition titled.

What I would do if money was no object?

I hope you enjoy the lesson.